IS101 — Introduction to Computing

Word Project — Core 1

Annual Business Report · Desert Sun Consulting · 100 Points · 31 Tasks

How to use this document: Complete each task in Microsoft Word using the guidance below. When you are done, upload your .docx file to the grader to receive instant feedback. Each task is worth the number of points shown. The total is 100 points.

D1 — Manage Documents (22 pts)

Task 1 **2 points**

Set 1-inch margins on all sides

Why this matters:
Consistent margins are required for professional business documents and APA/MLA formatting standards.

Where to find it:
Layout tab > Margins > Normal (1")

How you'll know it worked:
All four margins show 1" in the Margins dialog. The ruler shows 1-inch indents on both sides.

Task 2 **2 points**

Set orientation to Portrait

Why this matters:
Portrait is the standard orientation for business reports. The landscape section (Financial Summary) is handled separately in Task 15.

Where to find it:
Layout tab > Orientation > Portrait

How you'll know it worked:
The document displays in vertical (portrait) orientation.

Task 3 **2 points**

Apply the "Basic (Stylish)" style set

Why this matters:
Style sets control the look of built-in heading and paragraph styles across the entire document.

Where to find it:
Design tab > Document Formatting group > Style Sets gallery > Basic (Stylish)

How you'll know it worked:
Heading styles and body text take on the Basic (Stylish) appearance.

Task 4 — 4 points

Insert a header with the company name left-aligned and the date right-aligned

Why this matters:
Headers identify the document on every page and are required in professional reports.

Where to find it:
Insert tab > Header > Edit Header. Type "Desert Sun Consulting" on the left. Press Tab twice to move to the right side and type today's date.

How you'll know it worked:
Every page shows "Desert Sun Consulting" on the left and the date on the right in the header.

Task 5 — 3 points

Insert a footer with "Confidential" centered

Why this matters:
A confidentiality notice is standard for internal business reports distributed to stakeholders.

Where to find it:
Insert tab > Footer > Edit Footer. Center-align and type "Confidential".

How you'll know it worked:
Every page shows "Confidential" centered in the footer.

Task 6 — 3 points

Insert page numbers in the bottom-right of the footer

Why this matters:
Page numbers allow readers to navigate multi-page documents.

Where to find it:
Insert tab > Page Number > Bottom of Page > Plain Number 3 (right-aligned).

How you'll know it worked:
Page numbers appear at the bottom right of every page.

Task 7 — 3 points

Add a "DRAFT" watermark

Why this matters:
A watermark signals that the document has not yet been finalized or approved for distribution.

Where to find it:
Design tab > Watermark > DRAFT 1.

How you'll know it worked:
The word "DRAFT" appears faintly in the background on every page.

Task 8 **3 points**

Set document properties: Title = "Annual Business Report 2026", Author = "Desert Sun Consulting"

Why this matters:
Document properties store metadata that identifies the file in file explorers and document management systems.

Where to find it:
File tab > Info > Properties panel on the right side. Click the Title and Author fields and enter the values.

How you'll know it worked:
File > Info shows Title = "Annual Business Report 2026" and Author = "Desert Sun Consulting".

D2 — Format Text and Paragraphs (22 pts)

Task 9 **3 points**

Find and Replace: "DSC" with "Desert Sun Consulting" throughout the document

Why this matters:
The starter file uses the abbreviation DSC. The final report must spell out the firm's full name.

Where to find it:
Home tab > Editing group > Replace (or Ctrl+H). In Find: type DSC. In Replace: type Desert Sun Consulting. Click Replace All.

How you'll know it worked:
No instances of "DSC" remain in the document. The status bar confirms replacements were made.

Task 10 **3 points**

Apply the Title style to the document title "Annual Business Report 2026"

Why this matters:
The Title style formats the main document title consistently and distinguishes it from body text and headings.

Where to find it:
Click on the title text. Home tab > Styles group > Title.

How you'll know it worked:
The document title is formatted with the Title style (larger, bold, distinct from headings).

Task 11 **4 points**

Apply Heading 1 to all eight section headers: Executive Summary, Financial Summary, Quarterly Revenue, Client Portfolio, Strategic Objectives, Services Offered, Organizational Structure, and Conclusion

Why this matters:
Heading 1 marks the top-level sections of the document. These headings appear in the Table of Contents and give the document a clear hierarchy.

Where to find it:
Click each section header. Home tab > Styles group > Heading 1. Repeat for all eight headers.

How you'll know it worked:
All eight section titles appear in the Heading 1 style. The Navigation Pane (View > Navigation Pane) shows all eight listed.

Task 12 **4 points**

Apply Heading 2 to all subsection headers

Why this matters:
Heading 2 marks second-level content within sections, creating a two-level hierarchy in the document.

Where to find it:
Click each subsection header. Home tab > Styles group > Heading 2.

How you'll know it worked:
Subsection titles display in the Heading 2 style, visually subordinate to Heading 1.

Task 13 **2 points**

Set body text line spacing to 1.15

Why this matters:
Slightly increased line spacing improves readability for business reports.

Where to find it:
Select all body text (Ctrl+A, or select manually). Home tab > Paragraph group > Line and Paragraph Spacing > 1.15.

How you'll know it worked:
Body paragraphs have 1.15 line spacing. Check in the Paragraph dialog (line spacing shows "Multiple" at 1.15).

Task 14 **2 points**

Set 6pt spacing after each paragraph

Why this matters:
Spacing after paragraphs creates visual separation between ideas without double-pressing Enter.

Where to find it:
Select all text. Home tab > Paragraph group > click the dialog launcher. Set Spacing After to 6pt.

How you'll know it worked:
The Paragraph dialog shows "6 pt" in the Spacing After field for body paragraphs.

Task 15 **4 points**

Insert a Next Page section break before "Financial Summary" and change that section to Landscape orientation

Why this matters:
A section break allows different pages in the same document to have different layouts. The Financial Summary and Quarterly Revenue table are wider and benefit from landscape orientation.

Where to find it:
Click just before the "F" in "Financial Summary". Layout tab > Breaks > Next Page. Then click anywhere in the Financial Summary section. Layout tab > Orientation > Landscape.

How you'll know it worked:
The Financial Summary section appears on a new page in landscape orientation. Earlier sections remain portrait.

D3 — Tables and Lists (18 pts)

Task 16 — 4 points

Convert the pipe-delimited quarterly revenue data to a 4-column table

Why this matters:
Tables organize data so readers can compare values across rows and columns at a glance.

Where to find it:
Select all five lines of the pipe-delimited data (the header line plus four data rows). Insert tab > Table > Convert Text to Table. In the dialog, set "Separate text at" to Other and type the | character. Set number of columns to 4. Click OK.

How you'll know it worked:
The data appears in a formatted 4-column, 5-row table (1 header row + 4 data rows).

Task 17 — 3 points

Insert a new top row in the quarterly revenue table, type "Quarterly Revenue" in the first cell, merge all four cells in that row, and center the text

Why this matters:
A spanning title row identifies the table's purpose and is a standard professional table formatting technique.

Where to find it:
Click in the top row of the table. Table Layout tab > Insert Above to add a new first row. Type "Quarterly Revenue" in the first cell. Select all four cells in the new row. Table Layout tab > Merge Cells. Home tab > Center.

How you'll know it worked:
The top row spans all four columns and displays "Quarterly Revenue" centered.

Task 18 — 3 points

Create a 3-column table for the client list and sort it alphabetically by client name

Why this matters:
Tables organize list data professionally. Sorting the client list alphabetically makes it easier for readers to locate specific clients.

Where to find it:
Select the six lines of client data. Insert tab > Table > Convert Text to Table (separator: |, 3 columns). Then click anywhere in the table. Table Layout tab > Sort. Sort by Column 1 (Client), Ascending, Text. Click OK.

How you'll know it worked:
The client table is sorted A–Z by client name: CSN Foundation, Desert Medical Group, Las Vegas Convention Authority, Nevada Valley Bank, Oasis Events Management, Southwest Tech Solutions.

Task 19 — 2 points

Create a numbered list of the 5 strategic objectives

Why this matters:
Numbered lists signal priority or sequence and are the standard format for organizational objectives.

Where to find it:
Select the five objective lines under "Strategic Objectives." Home tab > Paragraph group > Numbering button.

How you'll know it worked:
The five objectives are numbered 1 through 5.

Task 20 **2 points**

Create a bulleted list for the Services Offered section — "Services Offered" is the Heading 1 above the list, not a bullet. The three main bullet items are Management Consulting, Technology Consulting, and Human Resources.

Why this matters:
Bulleted lists present non-sequential items clearly. The three service categories are the top-level bullets.

Where to find it:
Select the twelve service lines (do not select the "Services Offered" heading). Home tab > Paragraph group > Bullets button.

How you'll know it worked:
The three service categories and their sub-items are formatted as a bulleted list.

Task 21 **4 points**

Increase the list level for the sub-items under each service heading. Management Consulting sub-items: Strategic Planning, Organizational Development, Financial Advisory, Business Valuation, Mergers and Acquisitions. Technology Consulting sub-items: Digital Transformation, IT Strategy. Human Resources sub-items: Talent Acquisition, Training and Development.

Why this matters:
Sub-levels create a visual hierarchy that shows which services fall under each category.

Where to find it:
Select the five sub-items under Management Consulting. Home tab > Increase Indent (or Tab key while in the list). Repeat for the two sub-items under Technology Consulting, and the two under Human Resources.

How you'll know it worked:
Sub-items are indented one level below their parent category. The list shows three top-level bullets with indented sub-bullets beneath each.

D4 — References (10 pts)

Task 22 **3 points**

Insert a Table of Contents after the title page

Why this matters:
A Table of Contents helps readers navigate longer documents quickly.

Where to find it:
Click at the top of the document (before Executive Summary). Insert tab > Pages group > Page Break to create a blank page. Click on the blank page. References tab > Table of Contents > Automatic Table 1.

How you'll know it worked:
A Table of Contents appears on its own page, listing all Heading 1 and Heading 2 sections with page numbers.

Task 23 — 3 points

Customize the Table of Contents to show Heading 1 and Heading 2 only (2 levels)

Why this matters:
Limiting the TOC to two levels keeps it concise and avoids cluttering it with low-level subheadings.

Where to find it:
References tab > Table of Contents > Custom Table of Contents. In the dialog, set "Show levels" to 2. Click OK.

How you'll know it worked:
The TOC shows only Heading 1 and Heading 2 entries (no Heading 3 or deeper levels).

Task 24 — 4 points

Insert a footnote on the revenue figure in the Executive Summary citing the data source

Why this matters:
Footnotes provide citations and additional context without interrupting the flow of the main text.

Where to find it:
Click immediately after "$4.2 million" in the Executive Summary. References tab > Insert Footnote. Type the citation text in the footnote area at the bottom of the page.

How you'll know it worked:
A superscript footnote number appears after the revenue figure. The footnote text appears at the bottom of that page.

D5 — Graphic Elements (19 pts)

Task 25 — 4 points

Insert the DSC logo image and position it in the top-right area of the cover page

Why this matters:
A company logo on the cover page reinforces brand identity and gives the report a professional appearance.

Where to find it:
Click on the cover page near the logo placeholder. Insert tab > Pictures > This Device. Select your logo image file. Drag it to the top-right area of the cover.

How you'll know it worked:
The logo image appears on the cover page in the top-right area.

Task 26 — 3 points

Set text wrapping to "Through" for the logo

Why this matters:
Text wrapping controls how body text flows around an image. "Through" allows text to wrap through the transparent areas of the image.

Where to find it:
Click the logo image. Picture Format tab > Wrap Text > Through.

How you'll know it worked:
The image's Layout Options (or Picture Format > Wrap Text) shows "Through" selected.

Task 27 **4 points**

Insert a text box on the cover page with a report tagline

Why this matters:
Text boxes allow you to position text independently of the main document flow, which is useful for cover page design elements.

Where to find it:
Insert tab > Text Box > Draw Text Box. Draw a box on the cover page. Type a tagline such as "Delivering Results. Building Partnerships."

How you'll know it worked:
A text box containing tagline text appears on the cover page.

Task 28 **8 points**

Add descriptive alt text to ALL images in the document

Why this matters:
Alt text makes documents accessible to screen reader users and is required by accessibility standards.

Where to find it:
Right-click each image > Edit Alt Text. Type a meaningful description of the image. Repeat for every image in the document.

How you'll know it worked:
Each image shows a description in its Alt Text panel. Right-clicking any image and choosing Edit Alt Text shows non-empty description text.

D6 — Collaboration (9 pts)

Task 29 **3 points**

Add a comment on the revenue figure requesting verification

Why this matters:
Comments are used in professional workflows to flag items for review without altering the document text.

Where to find it:
Select the "$4.2 million" text or "$4,200,000" in the Financial Summary. Review tab > New Comment. Type your verification request.

How you'll know it worked:
A comment bubble appears anchored to the revenue figure. The comment text is visible in the comments pane.

Task 30 **2 points**

Reply to the existing comment from "Manager" in the document

Why this matters:
Replying to comments keeps review conversations organized and threaded in a single location.

Where to find it:
Find the existing Manager comment in the comments pane. Click Reply inside that comment. Type your response.

How you'll know it worked:
The Manager's comment shows a threaded reply beneath it.

Task 31 — 4 points

Enable Track Changes and make at least 3 edits to the Executive Summary

Why this matters:

Track Changes records every edit so reviewers can see exactly what was changed, added, or deleted.

Where to find it:

Review tab > Track Changes > Track Changes (toggle on — it highlights when active). Click in the Executive Summary and make at least 3 edits (add words, delete words, or change wording).

How you'll know it worked:

The Executive Summary shows tracked insertions (underlined) or deletions (strikethrough) in a contrasting color. The Review tab shows Track Changes is active.

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